EVERY VOICE DESERVES TO BE HEARD.

On 2 May 2025, Kyellu Hassan died in childbirth at Muhammad Shuwa Memorial Hospital, Maiduguri. She was Deaf. No interpreter was in the room.

02.05.2025

MAIDUGURI, BORNO STATE

THE INTERPRETER IS NOT IN THE ROOM.

HOSPITALS VISITED

21

HAD AN INTERPRETER

0

2024 Deaf Nigeria Pilot · Unmute field visits, 21 hospitals

A LOCAL PROBLEM WITH A GLOBAL MARKET.

70M
Deaf people in signing communities worldwide

300+
Distinct sign languages in use

500K
Culturally Deaf ASL users in the US

48.2%
Idaho ASL patients told no interpreter was available

$62
Median company-paid interpreter rate, per hour

SIGN LANGUAGE IS NOT UNIVERSAL

Unmute begins with a focused ASL healthcare use case. Every additional sign language needs its own vocabulary, its own validation and its own Deaf advisers. Nothing here transfers for free — and we do not claim it does.

1 IN 10
US ENCOUNTERS INVOLVE A PROFESSIONAL INTERPRETER

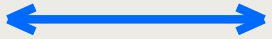
TWO DIRECTIONS. ONE SCREEN.

CLINICIAN TO DEAF PATIENT

Speaks or types a supported phrase

Unmute delivers the matching sign content

Patient watches it on the same screen



DEAF PATIENT TO CLINICIAN

Patient signs into the camera

Supported expressions recognised

Meaning shown as text and spoken aloud

SCOPE

About 20 healthcare expressions. Routine interactions only — not unrestricted translation. Outside the set, Unmute says so instead of guessing.

SUPPORTED EXPRESSIONS

~20

CAMERA IN. MEANING OUT.

01
CAPTURE
Camera input in the browser. No app to install.

→

02
RECOGNISE
Computer vision reads supported hand shapes and expressions.

→

03
INTERPRET
Mapped to healthcare meaning, not free-form translation.

→

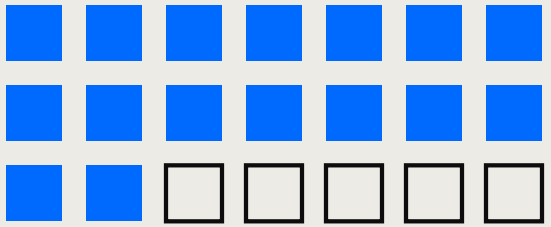
04
DELIVER
Text and speech for the clinician; sign content for the patient.

CURRENT STAGE

TWO-WAY PROTOTYPE — BOTH DIRECTIONS WORKING

Next: recognition accuracy, expanded healthcare vocabulary, and preparation for controlled hospital pilots.

21 HOSPITALS VISITED. 16 SIGNED LETTERS.



16 SIGNED LETTERS OF INTENT

5 VISITED, NOT YET SIGNED

21	hospitals visited and engaged
16	signed letters of intent
DEAF	community and NSL stakeholders engaged
NSL	professionals guiding development

NEXT MILESTONE — **MOVE FROM PROTOTYPE VALIDATION TO STRUCTURED HOSPITAL PILOTS**

THE HOSPITAL PAYS. THE PATIENT NEVER DOES.

WARD

UP TO 10 PRACTITIONERS

Routine bedside interactions

DEPARTMENT

UP TO 50 PRACTITIONERS

Shared vocabulary, named admin

ENTERPRISE

UNLIMITED SEATS

Integration, deployment support

SO WHY US

- Built for healthcare, not general conversation
- Both directions, not one
- Practical predefined interactions, so it can be trusted
- Cuts dependence on interpreter availability for routine moments
- Built with Deaf stakeholders and sign-language professionals

GRANTS AND PARTNERSHIPS

Sponsored deployments extend access to under-resourced facilities without making the company dependent on donations. Revenue stays the model.

NIGERIA FIRST. THEN ASL. THEN EVERY LANGUAGE.

01

NIGERIA · VALIDATION

Complete the ASL healthcare MVP

Work with initial hospital pilot partners

Validate accuracy, usability and demand

02

ASL MARKET EXPANSION

Additional institutions in ASL-using markets

Integrations and institutional partnerships

Improve the platform on real-world feedback

03

LANGUAGE LOCALISATION

New sign-language datasets and models

Local Deaf communities and qualified professionals

New healthcare markets, including Nigerian Sign Language

THE LONG-TERM POSITION — **ACCESSIBLE COMMUNICATION AS STANDARD HEALTHCARE INFRASTRUCTURE**

WHAT $10,000 BUYS.

40%	20%	20%	10%	10%
$4,000	$2,000	$2,000	$1,000	$1,000
PRODUCT	SIGN-LANGUAGE DATA	PILOT PREP	PRIVACY	M&E

A
More reliable healthcare MVP

B
Validated sign-language content

C
Initial hospital pilot deployments

D
Measurable performance and acceptance data

FROM VALIDATED PROTOTYPE TO HOSPITAL-READY MVP

NOBODY SHOULD BE LEFT UNHEARD.

Solo founder across product, research, partnerships and delivery. I took this to hospitals myself, sat with the Deaf community, and built relationships with sign-language professionals so the product answers a real need.

PRINCE NZUBUCHUKWU MICHAEL · FOUNDER

IMMEDIATE PRIORITIES

01 Complete the hospital-ready MVP

02 Begin structured hospital pilots

03 Establish a repeatable subscription model

GUIDANCE

Work is strengthened by people with practical experience in the Deaf community and the sign-language ecosystem. They are not yet members of the core team — supporting voices, not claimed staff.